

Shreyas N. Samaga

Applied Scientist
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Research interests Topological Data Analysis, Multiparameter persistence, Graph Neural Networks, Topological Deep Learning, Interpretability in LLMs, Agentic AI, Knowledge Graphs

Education **Purdue University** *West Lafayette, IN*
PhD in Computer Science *Aug 2021 – May 2026*
Advisor: Prof. Tamal K. Dey

Indian Institute of Science Education and Research Bhopal *Bhopal, INDIA*
BS-MS Dual Degree majoring in Mathematics *Aug 2015 – May 2020*
MS Thesis Advisor: Dr. Dheeraj Kulkarni

Appointments held **Applied Scientist Intern, Amazon** *May 2025 – Aug 2025*
Mentors: Neeraj Baji and Dr. Morteza Alizadeh
Built a scalable anomaly prediction framework for telemetry data using time-series foundation models, which can be used to predict network-related issues across Amazon Fulfillment Centers
The framework, a step towards proactive maintenance strategy, achieves an F1 score of 67% in predicting anomalous behavior in telemetry data when validated against historical high severity events

Research Intern, Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory *Jun 2023 – Aug 2023*
Mentor: Dr. Dmitriy Morozov
Worked on topological analysis of Zeolites (microporous crystals) using multiparameter persistent homology to capture their structure
Used gradient based tree learning for dimensionality reduction of the Persistence Images of Zeolites to reduce the redundancy in the captured topological information

Visiting PhD Student, INRIA Saclay *May 2023 – Jun 2023*
Mentor: Prof. Steve Oudot
Proved that GRIL (Generalised Rank Invariant Landscape), 2-parameter persistence-based vectorization (see papers), is stratifiably smooth and computed the gradient w.r.t. input bifiltration functions. Used this to build learnable topological layer based on 2-parameter persistence - D-GRIL (see papers)

Research Intern, Adobe Media and Data Science Research *May 2022 – Aug 2022*
Mentors: Piyush Gupta and Siddharth Ramesh

Used the topological information present in the self-attention maps of language models like BERT, when modelled as weighted graphs, to improve the performance on GLUE Benchmark tasks by about 3%

Explored the idea of topological distillation for self-attention maps in a teacher-student learning framework

Independent Researcher, Ethereum Foundation

Collaborator: Aditya Asgaonkar

May 2021 – Aug 2021

Identified critical network links that an adversarial attack could exploit to disrupt the network's functionality

Applied TDA techniques to Eth 2.0 network to strengthen the structural and health analysis of the network

Project Student, IIT Delhi

Mentor: Dr. Ishaan Gupta

May 2020 – Oct 2020

Evaluated the effect of hypertension and diabetes on COVID-19 mortality in India using machine learning models. People with diabetes are 2.11 times more likely to have a fatal outcome (see papers)

Predicted the mortality of COVID-19 using machine learning models with an AUC-ROC of 0.92 based on noninvasive blood parameter data (see papers)

MS Thesis, Chennai Mathematical Institute

Mentor: Dr. Priyavrat Deshpande

Jan 2020 – May 2020

Applied methods from Topological Data Analysis to a socio-economic dataset from India, as part of my MS thesis

DAAD WISE Fellow, Technische Universität Dresden

Mentor: Prof. Dr. Andreas Thom & Dr. Martin Nietzsche

May 2018 – Jul 2018

Worked on application of Algebraic Topology to Social Choice Theory and wrote an expository article (see papers)

Charpak Fellow, University of Strasbourg

Mentor: Prof. Athanase Papadopoulos

May 2017 – Jul 2017

Studied about homotopies and Poincaré groups of a topological space

Grants, awards and scholarships

Purdue Graduate Student Travel Grant, Purdue University	<i>2024</i>
NSF Travel Grant, NSF	<i>2023</i>
Research Grant for Beacon Chain Network Topological Analysis, Ethereum Foundation	<i>2021</i>
Director's Gold Medal, IISER Bhopal	<i>2020</i>
Department Gold Medal, IISER Bhopal	<i>2020</i>
DAAD-WISE Fellowship, DAAD	<i>2018</i>
Charpak Summer Research Fellowship, Campus France	<i>2017</i>
CNR Rao Education Foundation Prize, IISER Bhopal	<i>Aug 2016</i>
CNR Rao Education Foundation Prize, IISER Bhopal	<i>Jan 2016</i>

Publications

2026

Soham Mukherjee*, **Shreyas N. Samaga***, Cheng Xin, Steve Oudot, Tamal K. Dey. [D-GRIL: End-to-End Topological Learning with 2-parameter Persistence](#). *42nd International Symposium on Computational Geometry (SoCG 2026)*. Schloss Dagstuhl–Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, 2026.

Shreyas N. Samaga, Gilberto Gonzalez Arroyo, Tamal K. Dey. [HalluZig: Hallucination Detection using Zigzag Persistence](#), *Proceedings of the 19th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers) (EACL Main)*, 2026.

2025

Tamal K. Dey, **Shreyas N. Samaga** (author order acc. last name). [Quasi Zigzag Persistence: A Topological Framework for Analyzing Time-Varying Data](#), *Proceedings of the 1st Conference on Topology, Algebra, and Geometry in Data Science (TAG-DS 2025)*, in *Proceedings of Machine Learning Research* 321:147–165, 2025. **(Spotlight Oral)**

2024

Mustafa Hajij, Mathilde Papillon, Florian Frantzen, Jens Agerberg, Ibrahim AlJabea, Rubén Ballester, Claudio Battiloro, Guillermo Bernárdez, Tolga Birdal, Aiden Brent, Peter Chin, Sergio Escalera, Simone Fiorellino, Odin Hoff Gardaa, Gurusankar Gopalakrishnan, Devendra Govil, Josef Hoppe, Maneel Reddy Karri, Jude Khouja, Manuel Lecha, Neal Livesay, Jan Meißner, Soham Mukherjee, Alexander Nikitin, Theodore Papamarkou, Jaro Prilepok, Karthikeyan Natesan Ramamurthy, Paul Rosen, Aldo Guzmán-Sáenz, Alessandro Salatiello, **Shreyas N. Samaga**, Simone Scardapane, Michael T. Schaub, Luca Scofano, Indro Spinelli, Lev Telyatnikov, Quang Truong, Robin Walters, Maosheng Yang, Olga Zaghien, Ghada Zamzmi, Ali Zia, Nina Miolane (author order acc. to last name after first three authors). [TopoX: A Suite of Python Packages for Machine Learning on Topological Domains](#). *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, 25(374), 1-8, 2024.

Tamal K. Dey, Florian Russold, and **Shreyas N. Samaga** (author order acc. to last name). [Efficient Algorithms for Complexes of Persistence Modules with Applications](#). *40th International Symposium on Computational Geometry (SoCG 2024)*. Schloss Dagstuhl–Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, 2024.

2023

Cheng Xin*, Soham Mukherjee*, **Shreyas N. Samaga**, Tamal K. Dey. [GRIL: A 2-parameter Persistence Based Vectorization for Machine Learning](#). *Proceedings of 2nd Annual Workshop on Topology, Algebra, and Geometry in Machine Learning (TAG-ML)*, in *Proceedings of Machine Learning Research* 221:313–333, 2023. **(Spotlight Oral)**

2022

Mustafa Hajij, Ghada Zamzmi, Theodore Papamarkou, Nina Miolane, Aldo Guzman-Saenz, Karthikeyan Natesan Ramamurthy, Tolga Birdal, Tamal K. Dey, Soham Mukherjee, **Shreyas N. Samaga**, Neal Livesay, Robin Walters, Paul Rosen, Michael T. Schaub. [Topological Deep Learning: Going Beyond Graph Data](#). *arXiv preprint*, 2022.

Samarth Bhatia, Yukti Makhija, Sneha Jayaswal, Shalendra Singh, Prabhat Singh Malik, Sri Krishna Venigalla, Pallavi Gupta, **Shreyas N. Samaga**, Rabi Narayan Hota, Ishaan Gupta. [Severity and mortality prediction models to triage Indian COVID-19 patients](#). *PLOS Digital Health*, 1(3):e0000020, 2022.

2021

Sneha Kumar Jayaswal, Shalendra Singh, Prabhat Singh Malik, Sri Krishna Venigalla, Pallavi Gupta, **Shreyas N. Samaga**, Rabi Narayan Hota, Surinder Singh Bhatia, Ishaan Gupta. [Detrimental effect of diabetes and hypertension on the severity and mortality of COVID-19 infection: A multi-center case-control study from India](#). *Diabetes & Metabolic Syndrome: Clinical Research & Reviews*, 15(5):102248, 2021.

Yukti Makhija, Samarth Bhatia, Shalendra Singh, Sneha Kumar Jayaswal, Prabhat Singh Malik, Pallavi Gupta, **Shreyas N. Samaga**, Shreya Johri, Sri Krishna Venigalla, Rabi Narayan Hota, Surinder Singh Bhatia, Ishaan Gupta. [Challenges in the application of a mortality prediction model for COVID-19 patients on an Indian cohort](#). *arXiv preprint*, 2021.

2018

Shreyas Samaga. [On the homotopy type of choice spaces](#). *arXiv preprint*, 2018.

Research Projects

Developed a novel topological method to detect hallucination in LLMs, providing a new interpretability tool to understand why models fail by analyzing the topology of their evolving attention. We model self-attention matrices as graphs and weave the attention graphs in the different layers of an LLM into a zigzag filtration. Using zigzag persistence, we characterize the topology of hallucinated and non-hallucinated responses. We show that this framework can be used on a variety of datasets.

Proposed quasi zigzag persistence as a framework for analyzing topological information from spatiotemporal data. We vectorize this topological information using ZZ-GRIL and prove that it is stable. Further, we propose an algorithm to compute ZZ-GRIL by establishing the required theoretical results. We showed that this framework is applicable in various domains including sleep stage classification.

Developed and implemented algorithms for complexes of persistence modules. We extend the persistence algorithm to complexes of modules that are not free, which is a more general class of modules. We showed that these algorithms can be applied to compute persistent sheaf cohomology, which captures the information present in a family of sheaves over a simplicial complex.

GRIL: Generalized Rank Invariant Landscape, a vectorization scheme for 2-parameter persistence modules. GRIL does not need to reduce a 2-parameter persistence module to a family of 1-parameter persistence modules to vectorize it but vectorizes the entire 2-parameter persistence module at once. Experimentally, we showed that GRIL compares well with the existing multiparameter persistence vectorization methods.

Proved that GRIL is a stratifiably smooth map and computed an explicit formula for its gradient with respect to input bifiltration functions. Used this to build D-GRIL, an end-to-end learning layer based on 2-parameter persistence. This is one of the initial works on end-to-end learning using 2-parameter persistent homology. Showed that this can be used for bio-activity prediction in drug discovery, among other things.

Contributed to one of the foundational papers on Topological Deep Learning and [Topo-ModelX](#), a library for Topological Deep Learning.

Talks

Topological Data Analysis Seminar, Michigan State University	<i>Oct 2024</i>
Young Researchers Forum, Symposium on Computational Geometry 2024	<i>Jun 2024</i>
Math Graduate Symposium, Purdue University	<i>Mar 2024</i>
Topology Seminar, Purdue University	<i>Feb 2024</i>
Workshop on Topology and Geometry in Machine Learning, SoCG 2023	<i>Jun 2023</i>

Teaching experience

Purdue University

1/2 TA, CS 581: Algorithm Design, Analysis, and Implementation	<i>Spring 2026</i>
1/2 TA, CS 381: Introduction to Analysis of Algorithms	<i>Fall 2025</i>
1/2 TA, CS 580: Algorithm Design, Analysis, and Implementation	<i>Spring 2025</i>
1/2 TA, CS 531: Computational Geometry	<i>Spring 2024</i>
TA, CS 177: Programming with Multimedia Objects	<i>Spring 2022</i>
TA, CS 177: Programming with Multimedia Objects	<i>Fall 2021</i>

The Ohio State University

TA, CSE 1222: Introduction to Computer Programming in C++ for Engineers and Scientists	<i>Spring 2021</i>
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Service

I review for ICLR, NeurIPS (top reviewer 2024, 2025), ICML, AAAI and LoG conferences.

Was one of the local organisers of [ComPer Workshop 2023](#).